

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	
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Project Name	Automated Network Request Management System
Maximum Marks	4 marks

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Team Gathering & Collaboration Approach:

Our team conducted virtual and in-person synchronization sessions using collaborative developer workspaces to map out IT infrastructure inefficiencies. We focused our evaluation on how enterprise service teams handle network deployments, equipment modifications, and relocation workflows.

Selected Problem Statement:

The team identified that the legacy process for handling corporate network provisioning relied on fragmented communication channels (such as unmonitored shared mailboxes, manual Excel tracking sheets, and verbal notifications). This outdated approach created clear operational risks:

- **Incomplete Data Inputs:** Requesters regularly omitted business-critical physical data parameters (such as device context, extension layouts, or structural coordinates), resulting in protracted clarification loops.
- **Lack of Process Line-of-Sight:** Requests frequently stalled in administrative queues due to an absence of automated managerial validation routing.
- **Data Integrity Erosion:** Manually transcription errors during database entry led to mismatched hardware serial configurations, broken asset inventory dependencies, and faulty asset mapping records.

Step 2: Brainstorming, Idea Generation, and Categorization

Our team conducted a structured brainstorming session to identify potential solutions for improving the network provisioning process. The proposed ideas were grouped into three major categories based on functionality and implementation.

Group A: User Interface & Input Validation

- **Idea 1:** Develop a user-friendly self-service **Network Request Catalog** on the Service Portal to simplify request submission.
- **Idea 2:** Enforce mandatory validation for essential user and hardware details, including User Name, Email ID, Phone Number, and Device Type, ensuring complete and accurate submissions.
- **Idea 3:** Apply dynamic UI Policies to display location-specific fields only when the request type is **Relocation**, creating a cleaner and more intuitive user experience.

Group B: Workflow Automation & Approval Management

- **Idea 4:** Configure automated system notifications to alert the network support team immediately after a request is submitted.
- **Idea 5:** Design an intelligent approval workflow using **Flow Designer/Workflow Studio** to automatically route requests to the appropriate managers for review and approval.
- **Idea 6:** Implement approval-based flow conditions that prevent requests from progressing until they have successfully reached an **Approved** state.

Group C: Data Management & Storage

- **Idea 7:** Consider utilizing the existing Incident Management table to record and monitor network provisioning requests.
- **Idea 8:** Create a dedicated custom table (**u_network_database**) to securely store approved network request details, maintaining structured records while keeping operational ticketing tables free from unnecessary data.

Step 3: Idea Prioritization

The proposed solutions were evaluated using an **Action Matrix** based on implementation effort and operational impact. High-impact, low-to-medium effort solutions were prioritized, including a **Service Portal Catalog** with mandatory field validation, **dynamic UI policies**, **Flow Designer-based approval workflows**, and a dedicated **custom database table (u_network_database)** for structured data storage. These solutions were selected to improve data accuracy, automate approvals, and maintain a clean database architecture. In contrast, reusing native ticketing tables was rejected due to the risk of data inconsistency, while basic email notifications were retained only as a secondary communication mechanism rather than the primary workflow.

STEP 3: IDEA PRIORITIZATION – ACTION MATRIX

Evaluating Solutions Based on Effort vs Impact to Prioritize the Best Approach

SELECTED SOLUTION CONCEPT	REQUIRED COMPLEXITY (EFFORT)	OPERATIONAL RETURN (IMPACT)	PRIORITIZATION ACTION
 Portal Catalog UI with Mandatory Parameters	Low (Simple form field schema constraints)	High (Ensures 100% data completeness at input gate)	 High Priority: Adopted immediately as our front-end validation foundation.
 Dynamic Form UI Policies	Low (Conditional client-side visibility logic)	High (Streamlines user layout, only collecting data when relevant)	 High Priority: Adopted to handle dynamic relocation address parameters.
 Flow Designer Approval Integration	Medium (State tracking configuration and routing loops)	High (Removes manual validation overhead entirely)	 High Priority: Adopted as our primary process orchestration tool.
 Custom Database Tracking Table (u_network_database)	Medium (Dictionary adjustments, field layout creation)	High (Keeps network infrastructure ledger clean and isolated)	 High Priority: Adopted to guarantee database structure health.
 Reusing Native Ticketing Tables (Incidents/Tasks)	Medium (Heavy modification of baseline application fields)	Low (Creates data pollution and breaks standard database mapping)	 Rejected: Discarded to maintain clean system architecture.
 Basic Email Broadcast Alerts	Low (Standard system notification setup)	Low (Fails to enforce accountability or write structured data)	 Subordinated: Kept purely as a secondary activity logging fallback.



Our Focus: High Impact & Sustainable Solutions – Prioritizing automation, data integrity, and clean architecture for a future-ready network provisioning process.